



## SESSION 1: COACH

## Our identity

Who are we as a team?

**COACH OBJECTIVE**

You help the team form a shared identity. Players name values that matter to them personally and as a team. They connect those values to their behavior on and off the court.

**COACH NOTE**

Ask open questions, don't give answers. Your role is facilitator. Make sure every player gets to speak. Note the most frequently mentioned values, these become the foundation of the culture agreements. Pitfall: don't let one loud player dominate the discussion.

**ACTIVITIES****1 Check-in: one word**

⌚ 5 min

Ask each player: name one word that describes you as an athlete. Write all words on the board. Look for clusters.

**2 Our core values**

⌚ 15 min

Let the team work in pairs to choose three values they want to show as a team. Plenary exchange: which values come up most? Choose three to five team values together.

**3 Fill in the identity card**

⌚ 10 min

Players individually complete the identity card: as a team we are, we believe in, we choose to.

**NOTES**

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## DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Why did you choose these values?
- What does a player look like who lives these values every day?
- What changes if everyone does this?

## CLOSING

Summarize the three to five chosen team values and write them on a large sheet. Tell the group: this is who we are, this becomes our foundation for the rest of the season.

## NOTES

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*"Culture is not just one aspect of the game, it is the game."*

**Lou Gerstner, CEO IBM**